

products, the Apple II was still its biggest source of sales and the market was still dominated by IBM.

What put an end to Apple's troubles, however, was the introduction of the 'LaserWriter', an affordable laser printer and 'PageMaker', a desktop publishing program. Together, these two products established Apple as the only choice when it came to publishing. Its hold and identity as a machine meant for design were even more firmly established as Adobe, Quark and other companies began developing design software specifically for the Mac.

Learning from its mistakes, the 'Macintosh II' or 'Mac II' was launched in 1987. The watchword here was expandability and soon, Apple was rolling out over 50,000 Macs a month. While everybody rooted for Apple overthrowing Microsoft and coming out on top, it wasn't meant to be.

The many PC clones in the market running Windows made sure that didn't happen. The bigwigs at Apple considered licensing the OS to other manufacturers, but by then it was already too late and the idea was shelved. Instead, Apple tried to launch a few more variants of the Mac but they didn't do much to stand up to the competition. They were marketed badly and Apple was being called one of the most worst managed companies in the industry.

Up and at 'em

1991, on the other hand, proved to be much better for Apple. Not let down by the poor performance of the 'Macintosh Portable' released in 1989, Apple returned with a sleeker, more ergonomic 'PowerBook'. What made it revolutionary was the layout of the keyboard. While everything else in the market had the keyboard as close to the user's wrists as possible, the PowerBook pushed the keyboard towards the screen and dropped a trackball in the middle. The result: a place to rest your wrists and an idea the rest of the world followed.

The following year, Apple released the 'PowerBook Duo' – an even sleeker, slimmer PowerBook with stripped down internals. Its USP was the docking station into which it could be plugged that upped specs, making it a portable/desktop hybrid.

While things were looking good for Apple, the CEO, John Scully was slowly losing interest. He was replaced by Michael Spindler, who was Apple's COO in 1993. While Scully stayed on for a few months as chairman, he resigned several months later. '93 was also the year the 'Newton', Apple's PDA was released. Scully pushed for the development of this line, but its